

Those Absolute Essentials

Imagine buying a spanking new computer with all the frills – a high-end processor, gigabytes of RAM, a hard drive with a humongous capacity, DVD writer, the best graphics card money can buy, 7.1 surround speakers, 19-inch LCD etc. Finally you install Windows XP, the OS of choice for most users, on it. Now what? Though an operating system will get your machine up and running, it will not provide you with all the tools such as Antivirus, Photoediting, Text Editors, Spread Sheets, etc. that you might require. What if you want to protect your PC with antivirus software? The bundled utilities in Windows are not in most cases, the best in what they do, nor do they allow you to perform all the tasks that you want to.

Even the most high end hardware is useless without the right software. This book is the answer to your needs. Well almost. Here we cover various tools and utilities that you require to get the most out of your Windows machine, without being too heavy on the pocket, or for that matter, your PC!

For easy reference the book is categorised as per the tools and their functions and tries to cover the usage pattern of an average home user. Be it different aspects of PC-based entertainment, getting the most out of the Internet, playing with images, securing your computer from malicious code and hackers, reading and editing text, and system utilities to manage and maintain your Windows machine. The book aims to be a comprehensive guide to the most popular, and some not so popular (but still great) tools. Quite a few of the software tools covered in the book are either freeware or shareware. For added convenience, almost all the software reviewed here is provided in the Digit DVD that comes free with this magazine.

Each software tool is covered in detail. You will learn why it is good, what are its functions, the features that make it great and a lot more info about optimising the performance of the software and your hardware.

So lets Fast Track to those Essential Windows Tools!